

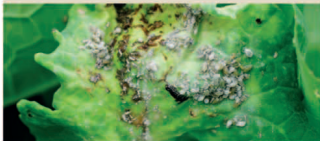


STORING IN A CLAMP

Rutabagas can be left in the ground over winter or, when harvested, stored in boxes packed with moist sand. Traditionally, however, rutabagas are stored in "clamps." To make a clamp, spread a layer of straw 8 in (20 cm) thick on the ground in a sheltered spot. Arrange your rutabagas in a pyramid, twice as wide as tall, with the largest at the bottom and the necks facing outward. Cover with an 8 in (20 cm) layer of straw, and, if the weather is particularly cold, a layer of soil as well. Pack down, and check occasionally for signs of pests or damage.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Rutabagas are prone to the pests and diseases that afflict members of the cabbage family: cabbage root fly, clubroot, flea beetle, mealy cabbage aphids, and mildew (see pp.246-7). Try using fine netting to deter cabbage root fly and flea beetles.



Aphids cause white blisters on leaves.